

Hannah Whitaker

Middle School Science Teacher

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Profile

Teacher with twelve years in the classroom, the last nine in grades 6 to 8 science. I plan hands-on, lab-based units, use assessment data to regroup students every few weeks and work closely with special education staff so every student can take part.

Licensure

Professional Educator License, Grades 4-9 Science and Language Arts from Ohio Department of Education July 2021

Google Certified Educator Level 1 from Google for Education March 2022

Experience

Science Teacher, Grades 7 and 8 at Riverside Middle School, Columbus, OH August 2019 - Present

Five sections of physical and life science, about 140 students a year.

- Rewrote the grade 8 physical science units around weekly labs; the share of students meeting the state standard rose from 61% to 74% over two years
- Science department lead since 2022: run monthly planning meetings and coordinate shared assessments
- Co-teach one inclusion section with a special education teacher and write accommodations for IEP students
- Started the after-school robotics club, which now has 25 members and competes in the regional league

Science Teacher, Grade 6 at Westbrook Middle School, Dayton, OH August 2016 - June 2019

- Taught life and earth science to four sections of about 28 students
- Built a school garden unit with the parent association that is still part of the grade 6 curriculum
- Mentored two student teachers from Wright State University

Grade 5 Teacher at Lincoln Elementary School, Dayton, OH August 2013 - June 2016

- Taught all core subjects to a class of 27 students
- Introduced a weekly reading conference routine and parent reading logs
- Led the grade 5 team’s move to shared unit plans and common assessments

Education

M.Ed. in Curriculum and Instruction at Ohio State University, Columbus, OH August 2018 - May 2020

B.S. in Middle Childhood Education at Miami University, Oxford, OH August 2009 - May 2013

Skills

Teaching: Lab-based science, differentiated instruction, formative assessment, co-teaching

Classroom: Restorative practices, small-group rotations, parent communication

Tools: Google Classroom, Canvas, PowerSchool, Desmos

Publications

Sink or Float: Teaching Density with Weekly Labs November 2023

H. Whitaker, R. Osei, Ohio Science Teachers Association Annual Conference
Workshop for middle school teachers on low-cost lab routines.

Volunteering

Lead Instructor at Columbus Summer STEM Camp, Columbus, OH June 2018 - Present

Plan and teach a two-week engineering camp for 40 students each summer.

Languages

English - Native

Spanish - Basic